

Year 7

Year 8

IGCSE

A-Level

I.B

ICT Fun

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Section 3.7: Comparison of Storage Media

In this section we will compare the storage media in terms of:

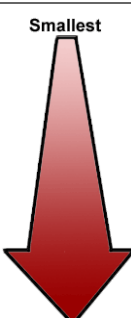
- **Amount of data stored** (capacity)
- **Speed of data access**
- **Portability**
- **Cost**

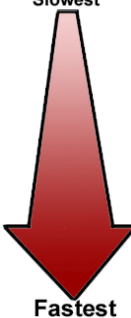
Note: The data on this page could change.

Key Concepts of this section:

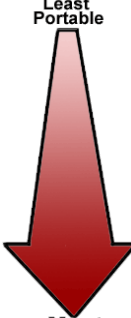
- # Know that storage media can be **compared**.
- # Be able to **compare** each of the storage media in terms of the 4 areas highlighted.

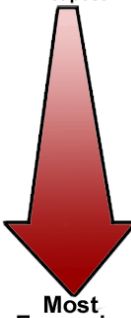
Solid State Media Comparison Tables

Comparing the amount of data stored (storage capacity)		
Low storage capacity 1.44MB - 800MB	# Floppy disk # CD-ROM, CD-R, CD-RW	Smallest  Largest
Medium Storage Capacity 4.7GB - 512GB	# DVD-ROM, DVD-R, DVD-RW # DVD-RAM # Blu-ray discs # Micro SD card, SD card # Memory stick	
High storage capacity 1TB - 185TB	# Solid state hard drives # Fixed hard disk, Portable hard disk # Magnetic tape	

Comparing the speed to access data		
Slow access speed	# Magnetic tape # Floppy disk	Slowest  Fastest
Medium access speed	# CD-ROM, CD-R, CD-RW # DVD-ROM, DVD-R, DVD-RW # DVD-RAM # Blu-ray # Fixed hard disks, Portable hard disk	
Fast access speed	# Memory stick # Solid state hard drive # Micro SD card, SD card	

Comparing how portable each storage media is		
Not portable at all	# Fixed hard disk	

		Least Portable
Quite portable	# Solid state hard drive # Magnetic tape # Portable hard disk	
Very portable	# CD-ROM, CD-R, CD-RW # DVD-ROM, DVD-R, DVD-RW, DVD-RAM # Floppy disk # Micro SD card, SD card # Memory stick	
		Most Portable

Comparing the cost		
Very cheap £4 - £10 - for packs	# Floppy disks # CD-R, CD-RW # DVD-R, DVD-RW, DVD-RAM	
Fairly cheap £15 - £50 - for 64Gb and above	# Memory stick # Micro SD card, SD card # Portable hard disk	
Expensive £50 - £300 - for 1TB and above	# Fixed hard disk, Portable hard disk # Magnetic tape # Solid state hard drive	
		Most Expensive

[Previous - Solid State Storage Media](#)[Next - Practice Test](#)

Links to Theory Units:

[Section 1: Types and Components of Computer Systems](#)[Section 2: Input and Output Devices](#)[Section 3: Storage Devices and](#)[Section 4: Computer Networks](#)[Section 5: Data Types](#)[Section 6: The Effects of Using](#)[Section 7: The Ways in which ICT is used](#)[Section 7: Part 2](#)[Section 8: Systems Analysis an](#)

Links to Practical Units:

[Section 9: Communication](#)[Section 10: Document Production](#)[Section 11: Data Manipulation](#)[Section 12: Integration](#)[Section 13: Output Data](#)[Section 14: Data Analysis](#)[Section 15: Web site Authoring](#)[Section 16: Presentation Authoring](#)[Back to top](#)